

SUPERVISED VOCATIONAL QUALIFICATION DIPLOMA - EXAMINATION

Session: Revision Mock Set 02	Duration: 3 hours
Specialty: Psychotherapy	Coefficient: 04
Eliminatory mark: < 8/20	Training reference: VTI-AEDA examination style

COMPREHENSIVE VOCATIONAL PAPER PRACTICE SET 02

Revision material based on the supplied VTI-AEDA 2025 examination format and the supplied psychotherapy course recordings. Not an official examination paper.

PART ONE: PSYCHOPATHOLOGY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (10mks)

- During assessment, Owen reports persistent psychotic illness with delusions, hallucinations and/or disorganized speech or behavior, often with social or occupational dysfunction. Which of the following is the BEST match?
 - Schizoid personality disorder
 - Manic episode
 - Schizophrenia
 - Stimulant intoxication
- Esther, a 38-year-old accountant, presents with sudden onset of delusions, hallucinations or disorganized speech/behavior lasting at least a day but less than a month, with return toward baseline. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?
 - Borderline personality disorder
 - Brief psychotic disorder
 - Schizoid personality disorder
 - Autism spectrum disorder
- Kemi, a 44-year-old farmer, presents with significantly low body weight, intense fear of weight gain and restriction without recurrent binge-purge episodes. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?
 - Social anxiety disorder
 - Anorexia nervosa, restricting type
 - Agoraphobia
 - Schizoid personality disorder
- During assessment, Esther reports significantly low body weight with anorexia features plus recurrent binge-eating or purging. Which of the following is the BEST match?
 - Anorexia nervosa, binge-eating/purging type
 - Social anxiety disorder
 - Brief psychotic disorder
 - Panic disorder
- A therapist notes that Kemi has recurrent binge eating followed by compensatory behaviors such as vomiting, laxatives or excessive exercise, without the persistently low weight required for anorexia. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?
 - Schizoid personality disorder
 - Specific phobia
 - Bulimia nervosa
 - Bipolar disorder
- Tina, a 30-year-old accountant, presents with recurrent binge eating with loss of control and distress but without regular compensatory purging or fasting. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?

- A. Binge-eating disorder
- B. Anorexia nervosa, binge-eating/purging type
- C. Substance use disorder
- D. Bulimia nervosa

7. Samuel, a 30-year-old sales representative, presents with a problematic pattern of substance use causing clinically significant impairment or distress, including loss of control, risky use, social impairment or tolerance/withdrawal. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?

- A. Borderline personality disorder
- B. Substance use disorder
- C. Panic disorder
- D. Anorexia nervosa, restricting type

8. A therapist notes that Daniel has initial euphoria followed by drowsiness or apathy, with slowed functioning and often constricted pupils. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?

- A. Opioid intoxication
- B. Anorexia nervosa, restricting type
- C. Social anxiety disorder
- D. Specific phobia

9. A therapist notes that Owen has euphoria, increased energy and confidence, decreased need for sleep, agitation and autonomic activation. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?

- A. Obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD)
- B. Manic episode
- C. Stimulant intoxication
- D. Major depressive disorder

10. During assessment, Wendy reports pervasive instability in relationships, self-image and affect, impulsivity, abandonment fears and recurrent self-harm or suicidal behavior. Which of the following is the BEST match?

- A. Obsessive-compulsive personality disorder (OCPD)
- B. Anorexia nervosa, restricting type
- C. Borderline personality disorder
- D. Obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD)

SECTION B: ANSWER TRUE OR FALSE (5mks)

1. Reduced need for sleep, grandiosity and pressured speech are compatible with mania. TRUE / FALSE
2. Bulimia nervosa necessarily requires markedly low body weight. TRUE / FALSE
3. Binge-eating disorder is defined by recurrent binge eating without regular compensatory behaviors. TRUE / FALSE
4. OCPD and OCD are identical diagnoses. TRUE / FALSE
5. Borderline personality disorder may include abandonment fears and recurrent self-injury. TRUE / FALSE

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (10mks)

1. Differentiate anorexia nervosa from bulimia nervosa. (2mks)
2. State two characteristic features of a manic episode. (2mks)
3. What is comorbidity? (2mks)
4. Name the four broad PTSD symptom clusters taught in modern formulations. (2mks)
5. What is meant by anhedonia? (2mks)

PART TWO: THEORIES/TECHNIQUES IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. A therapist working with Brenda uses an intervention characterized by turning back onto oneself what one wants to do to another, or doing to oneself what one wishes another would do. Which approach or technique is being used?
 - A. Retroflexion
 - B. Adlerian therapy
 - C. In vivo exposure
 - D. Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)
2. A therapist working with Wendy uses an intervention characterized by an approach emphasizing freedom, responsibility, choice, meaning, authenticity, isolation and awareness of mortality. Which approach or technique is being used?
 - A. Person-centered therapy
 - B. Interpretation
 - C. Existential therapy
 - D. Psychoanalytic therapy
3. In a session with Martha, the counselor emphasizes learning by association between stimuli so that a previously neutral cue comes to elicit a response. This BEST illustrates:
 - A. Free association
 - B. Classical conditioning
 - C. Existential therapy
 - D. Extinction
4. In a session with Uma, the counselor emphasizes behavior is shaped by its consequences, including reinforcement and punishment. This BEST illustrates:
 - A. Person-centered therapy
 - B. Operant conditioning
 - C. Psychoanalytic therapy
 - D. Negative reinforcement
5. In a session with Amina, the counselor emphasizes a behavior increases because it removes or prevents an aversive stimulus. This BEST illustrates:
 - A. Negative reinforcement
 - B. Person-centered therapy
 - C. Retroflexion
 - D. Interpretation
6. A therapist working with Irene uses an intervention characterized by a previously reinforced behavior decreases when the reinforcement maintaining it is consistently withheld. Which approach or technique is being used?
 - A. Psychoanalytic therapy
 - B. In vivo exposure
 - C. Extinction
 - D. Social skills training
7. Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: learning behavior by observing what happens to another person or by imitating a model?
 - A. Empty-chair technique
 - B. Social skills training
 - C. Systematic desensitization
 - D. Social modeling

- 8.** A therapist working with Fidel uses an intervention characterized by planned contact with feared stimuli, memories or situations while reducing avoidance so fear can be relearned. Which approach or technique is being used?
- A. Flooding
 - B. Exposure therapy
 - C. In vivo exposure
 - D. Existential therapy
- 9.** In a session with Uma, the counselor emphasizes direct, real-life exposure to a feared object or situation. This BEST illustrates:
- A. Adlerian therapy
 - B. Gestalt dream work
 - C. Rational emotive imagery
 - D. In vivo exposure
- 10.** In a session with Grace, the counselor emphasizes gradual exposure to a fear hierarchy combined with relaxation or another incompatible response. This BEST illustrates:
- A. Resistance
 - B. Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)
 - C. Cognitive restructuring
 - D. Systematic desensitization
- 11.** In a session with Esther, the counselor emphasizes rapid and prolonged exposure to a high-intensity feared stimulus or situation without gradual hierarchy progression. This BEST illustrates:
- A. Flooding
 - B. Transference
 - C. Extinction
 - D. Classical conditioning
- 12.** A therapist working with Martha uses an intervention characterized by systematically tensing and releasing muscle groups to learn physical relaxation and reduce arousal. Which approach or technique is being used?
- A. Gestalt therapy
 - B. Progressive muscle relaxation
 - C. Extinction
 - D. Psychoanalytic therapy
- 13.** In a session with Tina, the counselor emphasizes a skills-based therapy especially associated with emotion dysregulation and borderline personality disorder, using mindfulness, distress tolerance, emotion regulation and interpersonal effectiveness. This BEST illustrates:
- A. Empty-chair technique
 - B. Transference
 - C. Retroflexion
 - D. Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)
- 14.** In a session with Irene, the counselor emphasizes behavioral teaching and rehearsal of interpersonal skills such as greetings, eye contact, listening and conversation. This BEST illustrates:
- A. Social skills training
 - B. Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)
 - C. Transference
 - D. Flooding
- 15.** Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: the client says whatever thoughts, feelings, images or memories come to mind without censoring them?
- A. Free association
 - B. Psychoanalytic therapy
 - C. Operant conditioning

SECTION B: ANSWER TRUE OR FALSE (5mks)

1. Negative reinforcement weakens behavior. TRUE / FALSE
2. Extinction involves withholding the reinforcement that has maintained a behavior. TRUE / FALSE
3. Systematic desensitization classically combines relaxation with graded exposure. TRUE / FALSE
4. Flooding is always more gradual than systematic desensitization. TRUE / FALSE
5. Gestalt therapy emphasizes present-moment awareness. TRUE / FALSE

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (5mks)

1. State two core conditions of person-centered therapy. **(2mks)**
2. Give the ABC elements of REBT. **(2mks)**
3. Explain negative reinforcement with an example. **(1mks)**

PART THREE: PROFESSIONAL ORIENTATION AND ETHICAL/LEGAL ISSUES IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by a departure from customary therapeutic boundaries that may be clinically appropriate and non-exploitative in context. The BEST answer is:
 - A. Ethical response to colleague misconduct
 - B. Record keeping
 - C. Boundary crossing
 - D. Dual or multiple relationship
2. In professional practice, a situation calls for a serious harmful or exploitative breach of therapeutic boundaries. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
 - A. Boundary crossing
 - B. Gift decision-making
 - C. Technology ethics
 - D. Boundary violation
3. In professional practice, a situation calls for sexual or romantic involvement with a current therapy client. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
 - A. Beneficence
 - B. Gift decision-making
 - C. Mandated reporting
 - D. Sexual relationship with a current client
4. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by considering clinical meaning, value, timing, culture, power and exploitation risk before accepting or declining a client gift. The BEST answer is:
 - A. Nonmaleficence
 - B. Gift decision-making
 - C. Duty to warn/protect
 - D. Sexual relationship with a current client
5. In professional practice, a situation calls for accepting goods or services instead of money when ethically permissible, not exploitative and not clinically contraindicated. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
 - A. Duty to warn/protect
 - B. Privacy
 - C. Fidelity
 - D. Bartering
6. During supervision, Hassan describes maintaining accurate, timely, secure and clinically appropriate client records. Which concept should guide the discussion?
 - A. Confidentiality
 - B. Record keeping
 - C. Boundary violation
 - D. Privacy
7. During supervision, Kemi describes ending therapy responsibly with preparation, continuity planning and referral when needed rather than abandoning the client. Which concept should guide the discussion?
 - A. Record keeping
 - B. Bartering
 - C. Termination and referral
 - D. Fidelity

8. In professional practice, a situation calls for using ethical codes, consultation/supervision and appropriate reporting procedures when credible serious misconduct is observed. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?

- A. Informed consent
- B. Ethical response to colleague misconduct
- C. Sexual relationship with a current client
- D. Beneficence

9. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by protecting privacy, competence, informed consent, identity, emergency planning and data security when using digital or remote services. The BEST answer is:

- A. Informed consent
- B. Privileged communication
- C. Autonomy
- D. Technology ethics

10. In professional practice, a situation calls for not automatically disclosing the entire file on receipt of a subpoena; consult applicable law, the client/attorney and professional guidance, and disclose only as authorized or legally required. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?

- A. Subpoena response
- B. Ethical response to colleague misconduct
- C. Fidelity
- D. Bartering

11. During supervision, Brenda describes respecting the client's right to make informed choices about treatment. Which concept should guide the discussion?

- A. Subpoena response
- B. Veracity
- C. Confidentiality
- D. Autonomy

12. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by acting to promote the client's welfare and benefit. The BEST answer is:

- A. Duty to warn/protect
- B. Bartering
- C. Privileged communication
- D. Beneficence

13. In professional practice, a situation calls for avoiding or minimizing harm. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?

- A. Bartering
- B. Technology ethics
- C. Nonmaleficence
- D. Confidentiality

14. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by fair and equitable distribution of services, benefits, burdens and opportunities. The BEST answer is:

- A. Professional competence
- B. Record keeping
- C. Subpoena response
- D. Justice

15. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by truthfulness and honest communication with clients. The BEST answer is:

- A. Veracity
- B. Gift decision-making

C. Record keeping

D. Dual or multiple relationship

SECTION B: ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS CORRECTLY (5mks)

1. Give two elements of informed consent. **(2mks)**
2. When is termination ethically appropriate? **(1mks)**
3. State one key ethical requirement for clinical records. **(1mks)**
4. Why are dual relationships ethically risky? **(1mks)**

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (5mks)

1. What is a boundary violation? **(2mks)**
2. State two technology-related ethical concerns in teletherapy. **(2mks)**
3. How should a therapist respond to a subpoena for records? **(1mks)**

PART FOUR: CULTURAL DIVERSITY / GROUP THERAPY / COUNSELING PROCESS / TREATMENT PLAN IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. A trainee observes creating safety, trust, empathy and collaborative engagement at the beginning of counseling. This is an example of:
 - A. Rapport building
 - B. Cultural competence
 - C. Cognitive-behavioral group
 - D. Psychoeducational group
2. A trainee observes systematically exploring the client's problems, symptoms, context, history, strengths, risk and functioning. This is an example of:
 - A. Group role
 - B. Assessment
 - C. Termination and follow-up
 - D. Active listening
3. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: collaboratively defining client-centered outcomes that are realistic and observable?
 - A. Norming stage
 - B. Storming stage
 - C. Open-ended questioning
 - D. Goal setting
4. A trainee observes implementing agreed therapeutic strategies and monitoring the client's response. This is an example of:
 - A. Intervention stage
 - B. Professional interpreter use
 - C. Self-disclosure
 - D. Norming stage
5. A trainee observes reviewing progress, consolidating coping skills, planning relapse prevention or referral and ending the professional relationship responsibly. This is an example of:
 - A. Progress review
 - B. Rapport building
 - C. Termination and follow-up
 - D. Group confidentiality
6. In counseling practice, Xavier encounters a situation involving attending closely to verbal and nonverbal communication and showing the client that the message has been heard and understood. Which concept BEST applies?
 - A. Performing stage
 - B. Active listening
 - C. Rapport building
 - D. Cultural imposition
7. A trainee observes identifying and feeding back the emotional meaning expressed by the client. This is an example of:
 - A. Reflection of feeling
 - B. Self-disclosure
 - C. Adjourning stage
 - D. Skills-development group
8. A trainee observes restating the essence of the client's content in fresh words without changing its meaning. This is an example of:
 - A. Forming stage

- B. Paraphrasing
 - C. Cognitive-behavioral group
 - D. Self-disclosure
9. A trainee observes questions that invite elaboration rather than a yes/no answer. This is an example of:
- A. Reflection of feeling
 - B. Support group
 - C. Group confidentiality
 - D. Open-ended questioning
10. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: respectfully pointing out discrepancies between a client's words, behaviors, values or nonverbal cues?
- A. Support group
 - B. Performing stage
 - C. Cognitive-behavioral group
 - D. Therapeutic confrontation
11. In counseling practice, Amina encounters a situation involving the therapist deliberately shares limited personal information when it is likely to benefit the client rather than meet the therapist's own needs. Which concept BEST applies?
- A. Self-disclosure
 - B. Cognitive-behavioral group
 - C. Paraphrasing
 - D. Active listening
12. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: a collaborative written or explicit plan linking identified problems to goals, measurable objectives, interventions and review?
- A. Intervention stage
 - B. Norming stage
 - C. Assessment
 - D. Treatment plan
13. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: an organized explanation linking the client's presenting problems with relevant history, triggers, maintaining factors, strengths and a rationale for intervention?
- A. Case formulation
 - B. Goal setting
 - C. Forming stage
 - D. Ethnocentrism
14. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: evaluating whether objectives are being achieved and modifying the treatment plan when progress is absent, circumstances change or goals are met?
- A. Professional interpreter use
 - B. Skills-development group
 - C. Paraphrasing
 - D. Progress review
15. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: ongoing development of awareness, cultural knowledge, clinical skills and meaningful encounters with diverse clients?
- A. Norming stage
 - B. Cultural competence
 - C. Forming stage
 - D. Professional interpreter use

SECTION B: SHORT ESSAY (10mks)

1. Differentiate psychoeducational groups from skills-development groups. **(4mks)**
2. Define a treatment plan and list four common elements. **(4mks)**
3. Explain SMART goals. **(2mks)**

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SIMULATION OF REAL WORKING SITUATION PAPER PRACTICE SET 02

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SECTION I

1. Generalized anxiety and worry

Sasha, 59, worries most days about finances, health, family and work. The worry has persisted for many months, is difficult to stop, and is accompanied by muscle tension, restlessness and poor sleep. she repeatedly seeks reassurance but remains anxious.

Give the most likely diagnosis and show how CBT and relaxation/coping methods could be used. (25mks)

2. Panic with avoidance

Komiko, 18, has recurrent sudden episodes of racing heart, sweating, breathlessness and fear of dying. After several attacks in public places, he now avoids buses, markets and long queues and only goes out with a companion.

Formulate the problem and demonstrate a CBT/exposure treatment plan. (25mks)

SECTION II

1. OCD contamination and washing

Wendy, 25, spends several hours each day washing hands and cleaning after intrusive fears of contamination. she knows the rituals are excessive but believes that not washing could cause serious harm to family members.

What treatment technique is most appropriate? Demonstrate how you would use it safely and collaboratively. (25mks)

2. Social anxiety and skills practice

Mark, 32, avoids speaking in meetings and meeting new people because of fear of blushing, stumbling over words and being judged as incompetent. This is beginning to limit career and friendships.

Demonstrate a treatment plan combining CBT/exposure with social-skills methods where indicated. (25mks)